LVNA
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VILLAGER

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NEXT MEETING

Join us for a virtual discussion with Naomy Valdiosera, Community Navigator for Sunnyvale Community Services (SCS). Head over to svcommunityservices.org to learn more, donate, or volunteer.

Wednesday, November 10, 7:00 – 8:00 PM

Meeting sign-in link will be posted to LVNASV.org/meeting one hour before the start of the meeting.

If you weren't able to join us for last month's presentation on the Lakewood Branch Library, please note that we have changed our meeting platform from Zoom to Google Meet. Google Meet is available on both Android and iOS, but also offers a browser-based interface. If you would like to join through a mobile device, we recommend downloading the app prior to the start of the meeting.

HOLIDAY LIGHTS

It's almost that time of year to get out those lights and holiday decorations! Help make our neighborhood merry & bright!
PS. Remember to always use caution, especially if climbing on ladders and roofs. :)

LVNA PUMPKIN CARVING PARTY

On Halloween weekend, LVNA hosted a pumpkin carving party at Fairwood Park. It was great seeing our neighbors express their creativity through spooktacular pumpkin carvings and decorations!

Huge shoutout to Tatiana Colón for spearheading this event, along with the other board members.











INTRO TO YOUR LOCAL NON-PROFITS

Sunnyvale Community Services, 725 Kifer Rd

The important stuff first: **If you or someone you know in Sunnyvale (or the Alviso neighborhood in San Jose) needs assistance, especially with food or finances, Sunnyvale Community Services (SCS) can help. Please contact them at 408-738-4321**. Their programs (including monthly groceries with fresh fruits and vegetables) can help you cut down your cost of living and put your money towards other critical items. They provide emergency financial assistance (for rent, utilities, medical bills, etc.), case management (staff members help clients identify the right services), food assistance, kids' school supplies, and extra support for the holidays for those enrolled in the food program. For those who have trouble accessing services at SCS' site, SCS offers a Home Delivery Program to provide groceries and other services directly to clients' homes.



Who is this amazing organization? In 1970, members of the community joined together to help Sunnyvale residents access and benefit from a wide variety of services. Their mission is to prevent homelessness and hunger in our local community - with the vision of a community where everyone has a home with food on the table. The group started in a small room in St. Thomas Episcopal Church, and the organization was Sunnyvale Community Services. Since then, community need has only grown, due to the steep cost of living, few options for affordable housing, and an increasing wage gap that makes it harder for low-income households to afford basics like rent, utilities, and food.

SCS serves Sunnyvale residents and residents from the Alviso neighborhood in San Jose. Their clients include



many of our Sunnyvale neighbors: parents, working individuals, seniors, people experiencing homelessness. Clients represent a variety of people who never thought they'd end up in a financial emergency. Nearly half of SCS clients are seniors or children.



SCS also has special ties to our Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood. In 2019, when an apartment fire displaced more than 50 people in Lakewood, SCS ensured that everyone found temporary housing and followed up with each family to help them secure a new home. You can read about one neighbor's story at https://wishbook.mercurynews.com/2020/sunnyval. SCS runs a snack pantry program at Lakewood Elementary, ensuring students have kid-friendly snacks when they need them throughout the day. The agency serves more than 10,300 people each year, throughout our city.

Like everyone else, SCS has been heavily impacted by COVID and had already seen a surge in need in the years leading up to it. They've had a sharp increase in demand for financial help and have seen a 50% increase in the number of clients over a five-year period through 2020. With so many people losing their jobs (or having to quit their jobs to watch their children when daycares and schools closed), requests for financial assistance went up 600% in the first few months of shelter-in-place, and they had to hire more staff to support the community.

SCS made several changes to accommodate COVID safety protocols. More staff members worked remotely or started working on site on a rotating basis. Meetings with clients that were previously done in-person are now done largely through the phone or email. Clients who come to the building use an intercom to communicate with staff members and can complete program applications on outdoor tables. Food distributions continue to be done in a drive-through format, and other events (e.g., school supply drive and the Holiday Center) have switched to gift cards that are distributed at drive-through events as well. In spite of everything, SCS has not let covid interrupt their operations, not even during shelter-in-place, working five days a week to meet their clients' needs.

Prior to covid, SCS had already outgrown its space on Kifer Rd. Thankfully, they were able to locate, purchase, and renovate a new building - 1160 Kern Avenue (near Sports Basement). The building is 36,000 square feet, which will give SCS more room for private client consultations, volunteers, food storage, and space to host partner agencies. Ultimately, it will allow SCS to meet growing community needs for decades to come. As a bonus, it's closer to our Lakewood and Fairwood communities!

All of this important work depends on funding from community members, corporate or foundation donations, and government grants. If you want to make a financial donation, go here: https://svcommunityservices.org/donate-online/. Due to covid and building capacity, SCS cannot take physical donations at this time (either new or used items). Volunteers are always appreciated – you can sign up here: https://svcommunityservices.org/volunteer-sign-up/

ADVERTISE WITH US!

We have space throughout the Villager to host ads of various sizes. If you're interested in advertising with us, please email us at ads@lvnasv.org

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Finally, SCS has three annual fundraising campaigns. Before covid, SCS would accept donations of physical items but, since COVID started, all three programs switched to offer clients gift cards so they can safely select their own items (with the exception of school supplies, which are purchased and distributed in pre-packaged boxes). The first program is the Back-to-School Distribution Day, so families can receive school supplies and purchase backpacks and new shoes. The second program is the Holiday Center, so clients are able to purchase extra food and gifts during the holiday season. The third program is GivingTuesday, which happens every November - and as a bonus this year, anyone on their e-newsletter list will get a special invite for a virtual tour of their new facility! Sign up for their mailing list here: https://svcommunityservices.org/mailing-list/

Still interested in learning more?



Check out these videos on YouTube:

2021 Back-to-School Distribution Day: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGXcMPlr934

Helping during the COVID-19 Crisis: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QPl_7PEfcN4

Staying open in a pandemic: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z93ShyaPmyg

"Thank you" from a client: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QNoMXY0ia5E

Visit their website: https://svcommunityservices.org/



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MEET YOUR NEIGHBOR

Please email vp2@lvnasv.org if you want to recommend someone for an upcoming newsletter or if you would like to interview a neighbor for the newsletter.

DAWN HADDAWAY



Q: Tell me a bit about yourself and your family.

Dawn: I am a single mom, with 7 kids (ages 26, 22, 21, 20, 9, and two 7-year-olds). I have 6 boys and a girl (who will never date). Currently, I have just 4 children, 2 labs, and 2 guinea pigs at home. My kids at home are the youngest of generation one (20-yr-old son) and all of generation two (9-yr-old boy, 7-yr-old boy and 7-yr-old girl; the twins are birth siblings of the 20-yr-old). By the time my twins graduate high school, I will have had kids in school for 46 continuous years. Really. Although I am a white chick, we as a family literally check every single box on the ethnicity list and enjoy celebrating the diversity within our home as well as in our community. I consider myself from New Jersey, which is where I lived before I moved to CA in 1987, and I was raised in SE Asia (Hong Kong, Manila, Singapore).

I am probably best known for - and identify most as - a foster parent. After leaving the dot.com world, I was president of the executive board for the Santa Clara County non-profit that actively supports foster parents and foster children as well as develops DFCS and county-based policy for almost a decade. I retired and became a stay-at-home mom when my second generation of children had needs that sort of dictated how often I could work outside of the home. I've had scores of foster children in the past 20 years since I've been licensed, and I've adopted 7. Prior to being a licensed foster parent, I helped raise my niece and nephew who are what prompted the sudden move to Lakewood in 1996, when in search for a larger home. I was awarded the Sunnyvale Distinguished Resident Award in 2007 for my work as a foster parent.

Q: When did you move to the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood?

Dawn: 1996, as a renter in the same house I now own. Basically, I paid for it twice. lol.

Q: What street do you live on?

Dawn: Lakefair Dr.

Q: Name one thing you see out your kitchen window.

Dawn: My bird feeders and my fence.

Q: Something that is in your front yard?

Dawn: Roses, grass, kids riding bikes, and a few dead trees the city won't let me remove yet.

Q: A sound you hear frequently in the neighborhood?

Dawn: Birds and squirrels, the neighbor's chickens, the school bell from Lakewood, the occasional jet fly by, and the loud music when someone comes home each evening.

Q: What is something you like about living in Lakewood/Fairwood?

Dawn: The diversity. The multi-generational families that have been here forever. The home-based school, and school friends living near us. Giovanni's pizza just down the street. The fighter jets flying over our house from Moffett several times a year. Great America, too, where we can go early and get out before the big crowds are there many times each summer.

Q: And something that has changed since you moved to the neighborhood?

Dawn: Many of the homes are changing. The 1,108 sq foot isn't enough anymore. They are bigger and aren't the same 3-4 model homes anymore. I've added 1,600 sq ft to my home as well, but so far you can't tell from the front of the house. It still looks the same with the original 1957 giant window pane on the front wall. The stadium changed a lot, and since I'm not a Niners fan, I'm not so happy about that addition.

Q: What are your favorite parks/things to do in Sunnyvale and/or the Bay Area?

Dawn: We used to love the pool at Lakewood, I was sad to see that eliminated. Walking to the Lakewood park is always worthwhile, and Seven Seas is our favorite park. I can't wait to see what happens at the new Magical Bridge Park on Fair Oaks.

Q: Any great stories to share about living in the neighborhood?

Dawn: I'm a foster parent, and 10 months after picking up a newborn in 2012, he had a sister born into foster care and the county wanted me to adopt her as well. I was overloaded with my current children (committed to just boys unless a girl snuck in with a twin brother), and instead the sister was adopted by the only other Sunnyvale foster family who lived on Lakewood Drive, with the vision of having the siblings grow up together and know each other, by keeping them neighbors.

NEIGHBORHOOD SCAVENGER HUNT

Congratulations to Sarah O., who was the winner of the October scavenger hunt! She received a $10 gift card to Wal-Mart.

Welcome to the monthly scavenger hunt. Send your name, address (to confirm that you live in the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood), and answers to vp2@lvnasv.org by November 30, and we will announce the winner and the correct answers in the next newsletter. If there is a tie for the winner, we will randomly select one person as the winner. The winner will get to choose from a selection of $10 gift cards to local shops.

We are shortening the scavenger hunt to only three questions, due to reduced daylight hours and outdoor temps cooling down

1.True/False: There is a water fountain in one of the front yards at the intersection of Velvetlake Dr and Lakewood Dr.

(a) True
(b) False

2. How many houses are there on Ortiz Ct?

(a) 4
(b) 6
(c) 7
(d) 9

3. The guest speaker for the November neighborhood meeting is from which of these organizations?

(a) City of Sunnyvale
(b) Wal-Mart
(c) Sunnyvale Community Services
(d) None of the above

Answers from the October scavenger hunt:

1. What is the name of the greenbelt that runs through the Lakewood and Fairwood neighborhoods?

(b) John W. Christian Greenbelt

2. What color is the fire hydrant that is at the intersection of Burntwood Ave and Bridgewood Way?

(a) White

3. As you drive along Lakehaven Dr (going from Meadowlake towards Lawrence), you see a sign. What does it say?

(c) Speeding costs - $87 minimum - slow down

4. Who is the manufacturer of the picnic tables that are near the playground area of Lakewood Park?

(a) Pilot Rock

5. Which of the following is NOT an exercise included in the Vita Course set-up in the Fairwood neighborhood?

(d) Lunges

CUTTING EDGE
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Miguel Rios
650-810-6893

I offer landscaping services including fences, concrete, pavers, house interior and exterior. Prices are reasonable. I live locally and would love the support!

Instyle Beauty Salon, located in Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, is offering readers $150 off microblading, a new and popular procedure that creates the perfect eyebrow!

Normally $450, Instyle Beauty Salon is offering readers $150 off, making it just $300 for the procedure – which also includes the touch-up visit that is recommended within 4-6 weeks of the initial procedure.

Manual microblading is a form of a semi-permanent tattoo that involves using tiny needles (instead of a tattoo gun) that make up a small blade to help deposit pigment under your skin, one by one, for natural looking hair strokes. The procedure takes about an hour to 2 hours and lasts 1.5-2 years before needing to be redone to look fresh. Topical numbing cream is used to maximize comfort. Microblading is perfect for anyone with any hair color and is tailored to each individual client.

For more information and to schedule a consultation, call or text (408) 605-2146.









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IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
Abandoned Vehicles	(408) 730-7150
Shopping Carts and Graffiti	(408) 730-7680
Animal Control	(408) 730-7178
Neighborhood Preservation	(408) 730-7610
Parks & Maintenance	(408) 730-7506
Public Safety -- General Info	(408) 730-7100
Public Safety -- Non-Emergency	(408) 730-7180

LVNA MEETING RECAP

LVNA MEETING ON OCTOBER 13

Last month, Wendy Silver and Chaunacey Dunklee provided an update on the Lakewood Branch Library. Unfortunately, this meeting was not recorded. However, you can visit https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/business/projects/lakewoodlibrary.htm for additional information. A couple follow-up answers to neighbors' questions:

1. Are any streets going to be closed or impacted during the construction phase?
   Response: No streets are planned to be closed for the duration of the construction project. There may be periodic, limited impacts to traffic on Lakechime Drive and the parking lot near the pool will be closed for much of construction, but this will be coordinated with the school to minimize disruption as much as possible.

2. It is being built where the pool was. Are any other facilities permanently closing to accommodate the branch?
   Response: The swimming pool has been permanently closed for several years and will be removed and filled in with this project to provide additional parking for the new building. The new library will be built where the small softball field directly south of the pool is currently, but all other school and park facilities will remain.

Thank you, again, to Wendy and Chaunacey for providing insight and clarity on this exciting new project coming to our backyard!

UPCOMING EVENTS

NOVEMBER

10 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Meet link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

DECEMBER

08 lvna monthly meeting
virtual Meet link: lvnasv.org/meeting
7:00 - 8:00 PM

For all Sunnyvale events, please refer to Sunnyvale's online calendar at https://sunnyvale.ca.gov/cals/.